# 2012 Nissan Sentra 2.0 S

$6,175 · 107,200 miles · Dealer · Ridgecrest, CA

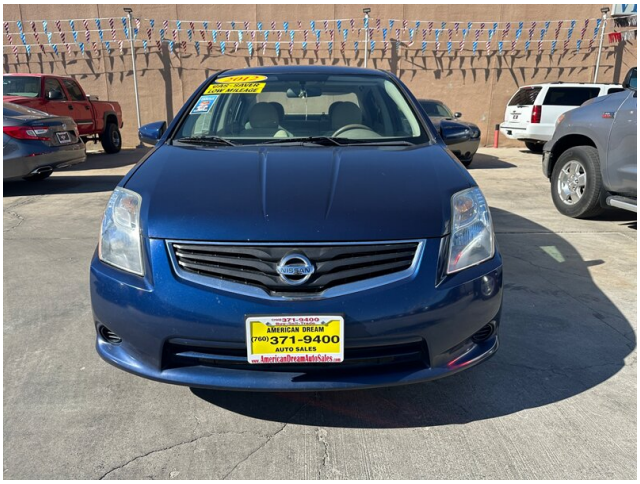
Seller: American Dream Auto Sales (Ed), 239 E Ridgecrest Blvd

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/3N1AB6AP4CL772833/2012-nissan-sentra-2-0-s-cvt-ridgecrest-ca

Report generated October 27, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder











+ 8 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$7,099** | **$531** | **Below average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 2/5 · 0 recalls · 180 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $6,175.00 |
| Sales tax (9.25%) | $571.19 |
| Dealer doc + filing fees | $125.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $40.14 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $7,099.32 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $2,099.32 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $42.07 |
| Total interest over the loan | $424.64 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $42.07 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 30 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $158.33 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $180.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $15.84 |
| Total per month | $531.24 |

Running costs without the loan: **$489/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$13,265** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Below average (2/5)**

Below average. The engine is fine and it gets 27 city / 34 hwy MPG, but 2007-2012 Sentras are known for CVT transmission failures - 'Power train' is the top NHTSA complaint (68 of 180) - and Nissan's extended CVT warranty has expired.

NHTSA data for this model year: 0 recalls · 180 owner complaints (10 involving a crash). Most complaints: Power Train (68), Engine (39), Vehicle Speed Control (22), Unknown Or Other (21), Air Bags (20), Structure (17).

**Known issues for this model**

• CVT (JF011E) whine, shudder, overheating 'limp mode' or failure - often $3,000-4,000

• Ex-fleet: hard use, basic maintenance

• Engine mount wear

**Check on this car before buying**

• Ask for CVT fluid change records (none = big risk)

• Long test drive incl. a hill: no whine, slipping or rpm flare

• Inspection with a CVT scan for stored codes

• Dealer handles smog; ask about the 3-day return right (CARS Act)

## Notes

Dealer stock #10337R1. $6,175, 107,200 mi, 2.0L, CVT, blue/gray. Clean title, ACCIDENT FREE, fleet history (AutoCheck).

Price 7% above market avg $5,796. Target ~$5,500.

Good gas mileage (27 city), but this generation's CVT is the main risk.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.